

choices: “File System: UFS (GPT and Soft Updates),” “Minimum Free Space (8),” and “Don’t Erase MBR (unchecked).” Click the Format Disk button.

Before you can access a drive, you have to mount it. So go back to the left-hand Disks menu and click “Mount Point”. Click the circled plus sign, select “Disk” from the dropdown Type menu, and choose your hard drive from the dropdown Disk menu. Select “EFI GPT” from the Partition menu and UFS for the File System value. Click the Add button when you’re finished. An OK message in the Status window indicates that the drive was successfully mounted.

Enable services and create shares

We need to be able to access our NAS box using computers running Windows, so it’s essential that we enable the SAMBA networking protocol on our NAS box. Look in the left-hand column for the heading labeled Services and click the CIFS/SMB menu item. Place a check mark next to “Enable” in the main window but leave all the values at their default settings. Click the Save and Restart button.

Now that you have SAMBA up and running, you’ll have to create one or more network shares. This will allow your remote computers to treat the NAS box’s hard drive(s) as though they’re a local resource – which is why we made the NAS in the first place.

So click the Shares tab in the “Services: CIFS/SMB: Settings” window and click the circled plus button. In the screen that appears next, share a name, add a comment describing the purpose of the share, set the path and click the Add button. Click the Apply Changes button on the next screen. When you’ve finished configuring FreeNAS, click the Backup/Restore button to create a backup of your configuration. You should now be able to find your NAS and your newly created shared folders listed in your network places.

How to stream from your NAS box

Now that your new NAS box is ready to go, getting all your movies and photos to stream to your media device of choice is extraordinarily easy. Here’s how you do it.

- ▶ To get started, head into the web configuration for your NAS and go to **Services > UPnP**.
- ▶ Click the Enable checkbox on the right-hand side and give your UPnP server a name.